

The Exile

In 597 Judah participated in a rebellion of minor powers against Babylon which was crushed in 588 B.

Jehoiachin, the newly crowned king, along with government officials, important citizens and priests were exiled to Babylon.

Zedekiah became king of Judah. he didn't learn from the recent rebellion and began plotting another rebellion.

Jeremiah warned him but the king could not deter the patriotic drive for political independence.

in 586 rebellion broke out and in July, 586 Jerusalem fell and was razed to the ground.

Jeremiah had a vision of the new covenant which would herald salvation for Israel:

Behold the days are coming, says the Lord, when I will make a new covenant with the house of Israel and the house of Judah, . . . for I will forgive their iniquity, and I will remember their sin no more.

(Jer. 31:31-34)

Man had been unable to change himself, so that God had had to transform him inwardly.

Ezekiel prophesied from Babylon trying to give comfort to the exiles.

He had tremendous zeal and called on the captives to repent.

first, he taught that God's actions were just, for the sins of Israel had merited the wrath he visited upon them.

By justifying God's ways it enabled the exiles to recover the inner strength required for the reconstruction of a community dedicated to YHWH's service on foreign soil.

from this time on, in fact, the main thought in Judaism came from Babylon, not Jerusalem.

second Isaiah, which begins with chapter 40, are close in style and spirit to the original Isaiah.

He taught that YHWH had a plan for universal redemption, and it involved the special participation of his chosen

Israel must spread the message of redemption and must demonstrate God's saving power to the nations. people.

This task would be difficult, entailing suffering and humiliation.

The suffering servant passages in Isaiah 42-53 are addressed by YHWH to an idealized figure, perform the labor.

commissioned to

no one would listen to him or notice him but in the future all would listen to him.

Deutero-Isaiah's image of the servant became the model for Israel, which interpreted its suffering of the present as having redemptive value.

Israel must become the servant bearing witness to YHWH. a great messianic hope arose at this time looking toward the
2

time when all nations acknowledged YHWH as sovereign king and God.

universal peace would reign, the cosmos would be transformed, Rightousness and peace would prevail among all creatures.

the prophet conceived YHWH's plan to be the progressive revelation of himself to the nations thru the special mission of Israel toward the end goal of universal knowledge and universal peace.

The destroyed national institutions of Jewish life were replaced in Babylonia by two key religious institutions around which community life was ordered. These were the synagogue and the Torah.

without the temple, they now had to substitute for the official cult.

prayer in sanctuaries consecrated by the people, fasts, and the Sabbath celebration formed the core of the new worship.

The religious and national **unity** of Israel had been gravely challenged by the destruction and exile, and the challenge was met by the resolution to remain loyal to YHWH and the religious values of the covenant tradition.

The traditions telling of YHWH's acts and his relationship to Israel were gradually gathered together in Babylonia by the Priests. These men edited the various traditions inserting their own and compiled a history of the
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world from creation, preserved in ordered form the words of the prophets and formulated a priestly code of ritual laws grounded upon earlier cultic prescriptions.

Acquiring knowledge of the past and fulfilling God's commandments became the most sacred activity in the religious life of the Jew.

Israel interpreted their duty to remain holy as a duty to

remain separate and distinctive.

This meant to remain holy and distinctive in conditions of exile that legal prohibitions were imposed such as those against mixed marriage and dietary laws.

the calendar of special religious observances separated Jews from non-Jews and symbolized the determined separate existence of Israel.

When Cyrus the Great won victory over Babylonia he appeared as a messianic figure to many Jews who saw Isaiah's prophecy coming true.

In 538 B. Cyrus issued an edict telling the Jews they could return home to Israel. It is certain that the initial response of the exiles was weak and in fact, few actually went back.

Psalms 23 comes from this period trying to encourage the exiles to go home.

reestablishment was difficult though the temple was rebuilt in 515 B. after a 20 year struggle to obtain funds and labor.

4

Nehemiah was appointed by the Persian court and arrived in Palestine between 444 and 449 and proceeded to set up a strong and honest government.

He fortified the walls around Jerusalem and provided the residents with security from external threat

Ezra the scribe came from a priestly family. He brought with him to Palestine the code of the law of Moses, consisting either of the entire Pentateuch or large parts of it compiled by the priests in Babylonia. He proclaimed this code as the law of the land in the name of the King of Persia.

He was very strict and the books of Ruth and Jonah were written at this time protesting the exclusiveness of the new attitude.

during this time the Five books of the Law were finally canonized.

This "Torah" was disseminated among the people.

The Jew, no matter where he lived, was to be defined as one loyal to the Law of YHWH, one devoted to the ancient Intertestamental period

Persian Period

Local control and good government.

Religion was left alone and the Jews that stayed in Babylon prospered.

Egypt, Judea-- cultural and priestly class became more In developed and the greatest thought in Judaism remained in Babylon from then on. Alexander the Great

333-323,

conquered to Indus river

in India, Afghanistan to Egypt--all--.

Greeks felt missionary enterprise to spread Greek language and civilization wherever they went.

conquered Jerusalem--so powerful there was no contest.

took Tyre finally by building a causeway to island.

Carthage becomes the only remaining center of Canaanite civilization.

great intellectual impact on all peoples.

When Alexander died, successors divided Syria and Egypt.

Judea on boundary. (Judah is Hebrew, Judea Greek).

point of contention (see Daniel and Zec. 9:13).

military tower was built overlooking the temple courtyard. (I Mac 1:42-43). Greek control of area though at first worship was left alone.

Greek customs were adopted by the Jews in Jerusalem however including gym, games and competition in the nude. Stricter Jews were scandalized and eventually there was war over the cultural clash.

Antiochus IV Epiphanes- 168 B.C.E. tried to conquer Egypt but was rebuffed by the Romans.

he went through Jerusalem on retreat and set up a statue of Zeus (I Mac 1:41-64) as part of his "Greekizing program.

This was the

11:31

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"abomination of desecration spoken of in Dan.

from 167-164 B.C.E. offered hogs as sacrifice to Zeus on altar in the temple and totally scandalized the orthodox JEWS, sacrifice of swine continues for 3 and a half years, the time, two times and a half time of Daniel 12:7. Maccabean Revolt begins. These are rural priests, not of the Levite tribe.

several brothers involved, successful general warfare they took several towns, had spectacular victories and

support of common people.

164 B.C.E they cleansed the temple, throwing out the statue of Zeus 3 and a half years after it was placed there.

this is origin of the Jewish holiday of Hanacuh. story is that there was only enough oil to burn the lamps needed for cleansing for one night but by a miracle, it burned for 8 days. Thus the feast of lights' lasts 8 days.

in 148 the tower was cleared from the temple area thru negotiations.

Edom to Ideomenia--forcable conversion--Samaria at same time- split this is the source for the hate of Samaritans in Jesus day. Orthodox Jews felt they had become to multi-cutured even tho they used only the pentatuch as their

7

scripture, they had there own temple.

Borders of Judah and Israel were pushed to that of 800 B.C.E.

Support from Hasadim-pious ones. became the Pharasees of Jesus time.

Greek aristocrats who remained under Greek influence and education:

aristocracy--became the Saducees.

Macabees were not in proper priestly line which caused split. those who felt only the proper line should be priests split off from the 2nd temple and became the Essenes who produced the Dead Sea Scrolls.

Last daughter of the Macabees married into and Ideomenian family of Antipater who was not accepted by pious jews since they had been forcibly converted only a generation before.

Antipater began to rule in 63 B.C.E. when the Romans took Jerusalem without siege due to internal Jewish fights.

Antipater is father of Herod I (Great) who lived till 4 B.C.E. and under whom Jesus was born.

I Macabees is good history

II Macabees more biased and sectarian history

Daniel fair history from 175-150 B.C.E. if read between the lines of visions.

Worship

Psalms: were the hymnal of the 2nd temple (rebuilt starting in 520 B.C.e.) spoken of in Psalm 69:7-21.

the royal psalms were pre-exilic some dating from the time of the monarchy perhaps as early as David and Solomon. but most date from after the exile. ex. Psalm 23 was a

psalm written to encourage the exiles to go home after Cyrus allowed them to leave Babylon in 536 B.C.E. Dates from same time as II Isaiah

II Isaiah (chap. 40-65).

vestiges of earlier worship, some borrowed from surrounding cultures.

Example. YHWH as a rider of the clouds is similar to a Canaanitic poem extolling Baal as rider of the clouds.

The Psalms were collected and used from about 520-150 B.C.E.

psalm 151 appears in the Eastern Orthodox Bible tho not in any western Bibles, other than the newest Oxford annotated.

Ps. of Solomon--150-50 B.C.E. had theme of Messianic hope as well as used for worship.

Wisdom literature

highly developed in this inter-testamental period. Ben Sirach in the apocrypha is best of these.

His

"and now let

us praise famous men" in 44:1-23ff is where Hebrews gets the format for its list in the faith chapter, 11.

Wisdom becomes personified in this time. Prov. 8:22-31, and Wis. of Sol. in the Apoc. 7:22b-81 are good examples.

Wisdom (sophia) is "the first-born of all creation" an idea

9

applied to Jesus in Col 1,

John uses the greek masculine form logos" in his prologue to say Jesus is wisdom in the flesh,

equating him

with God. He does not say he was the first born of all creation, but rather he was the creator.

Jewish nationalism- found in books of Esther, Judith (she seduces an enemy general and then while he sleeps kills him), Tobit, Additions to Daniel, and the Essene book found at the Dead sea of "The war of the sons of light and the sons of darkness

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Visions-apocalyptic lit. found in Enoch, 1 and 2 Esdras, and Jubilees.

Literature in test. of the 12, Job and Ecclesiastes.

It must be realized that during the intertestamental

period the influence from Persia (Iran) and the Zoroastrian dualism of good vs evil became a large factor in Jewish thinking.

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It is at this time that concepts of later Judaism such as Devils, angels, and most important for Christians, the resurrection of the dead came into Jewish thinking. Before this time there is no idea of eternal life except thru your children.

The Canon was decided in the Council of Jamnia in 91 C.E.

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after the church and synagog had split. prot. adopted Jewish canon of 91 for O. T. while Cath. use more liberal greek septuagint which included the apocryphal books.